



2026 MWRD: RESPECT, CIVILITY & INCLUSION

Instructor-Led Training

FACILITATOR GUIDE

Employee Edition | 2026

Metropolitan Water Reclamation District of Greater Chicago

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This Facilitator Guide is the operational companion to the MWRD Respect, Civility & Inclusion Employee Edition ILT. It is designed for trained facilitators delivering this course in person. It is not a participant document and should not be distributed to learners.

HOW TO USE THIS FACILITATOR GUIDE

This guide is organized into a three-column format that mirrors the sequence of the PPT deck slide by slide. Use it on a printed copy or a second screen during delivery.

Column 1: Slide #	Column 2: Facilitator Notes	Column 3: Notes
Each row identifies the slide number and type of content (timing, activity, etc.). Activity rows use a teal label. Timing rows use navy.	TIMING: Estimated duration for the slide, activity, discussion, or debrief segment. SAY: Verbatim or near-verbatim facilitator script to support consistent delivery and policy-aligned messaging. ASK: Discussion questions used to encourage participation, critical thinking, reflection, and policy application. LEARNERS DO: Participant actions, table discussions, reflections, partner work, role plays, movement activities, or scenario analysis tasks. FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Specific facilitator actions for managing delivery, transitions, activities, room dynamics, psychological safety, technology, and learner engagement.  FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Cue for the facilitator to open, review, and reference the applicable MWRD policy language directly with participants before returning to the PPT slide. DEBRIEF: Key teaching points, clarification guidance, and transition language used to reinforce learning outcomes and connect discussion responses back to workplace expectations and policy.	Facilitator coaching notes, delivery tips, common learner reactions, "If asked" response scripts, and risk alerts. For your eyes only — never read aloud.

Keep this guide on a second screen or as a printed copy. Do not project it. Participants should never see it.

FACILITATOR PREPARATION

Before the Day: Facilitator Preparation Checklist

☐ POLICY ACCESS	Have all four policy documents open in a browser tab or printed: AP 10.5.0 (Anti-Harassment/Discrimination), AP 10.11.0 (Whistleblower), AP 10.15.0 (Complaint Procedure), AP 10.27.0 (Rules for Employee Conduct). Policy portal: mwrdd.org > Departments > HR.															
☐ PPT DECK	Open the Employee Edition PPT on your presentation device. Advance through all slides once and confirm all builds/animations work. Know which slides have audio or video embeds.															
☐ VIDEO	Test the video for Activity 2. Confirm audio plays through room speakers. Have a backup plan if video fails: be prepared to describe the scenario verbally using the slide notes.															
☐ ACTIVITY MATERIALS	Print out Scenario Cards (Activity 3) per table/group and tent cards for the Workplace Behavior Spectrum Sort. Print enough Role Play scenario sheets (Activity 4) for all participants (1 per group/table of 3).															
☐ PARTICIPANT GUIDES	Confirm you have one Participant Guide per attendee. Distribute these before until directed in the guide.															
☐ ROOM SETUP	Arrange the room for small-group interaction if possible. Tables in clusters of 3–5 is ideal. If the room has fixed seating, a single long conference table, or rows you cannot rearrange, see the Room Adaptation Notes below before arriving.															
☐ ROOM ADAPTATION	This training will be delivered at several MWRD locations with varying configurations. Here is how to adapt each activity when standard group seating is not available. <table><thead><tr><th>Room Type</th><th>What You Have</th><th>Adaptation</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Café tables (small square, 3–4 chairs)</td><td>Natural small groups</td><td>Ideal. No adaptation needed. Assign one set of scenario cards per table.</td></tr><tr><td>Classroom rows (folding tables, seats facing forward)</td><td>Rows of 2–4 per table</td><td>For table discussions, pair the person directly across the aisle as the second group member. For Spectrum Sort and Role Play, groups of 3 can work across two adjacent tables.</td></tr><tr><td>Single conference/boardroom table</td><td>One large group</td><td>Run all "table" discussions as whole-group discussions. For Spectrum Sort, give one set of cards to the full group and facilitate as a full-class sort with volunteers. Role Play works in triads — seat three chairs together at one end of the table.</td></tr><tr><td>Fixed or theater-style seating</td><td>Cannot rearrange</td><td>For all discussions, use think-pair-share with the person next to them. For Spectrum Sort, read each card aloud and do a whole-group consensus sort using a show-of-hands or verbal vote. For Role Play, ask for three volunteers to come to the front.</td></tr></tbody></table>	Room Type	What You Have	Adaptation	Café tables (small square, 3–4 chairs)	Natural small groups	Ideal. No adaptation needed. Assign one set of scenario cards per table.	Classroom rows (folding tables, seats facing forward)	Rows of 2–4 per table	For table discussions, pair the person directly across the aisle as the second group member. For Spectrum Sort and Role Play, groups of 3 can work across two adjacent tables.	Single conference/boardroom table	One large group	Run all "table" discussions as whole-group discussions. For Spectrum Sort, give one set of cards to the full group and facilitate as a full-class sort with volunteers. Role Play works in triads — seat three chairs together at one end of the table.	Fixed or theater-style seating	Cannot rearrange	For all discussions, use think-pair-share with the person next to them. For Spectrum Sort, read each card aloud and do a whole-group consensus sort using a show-of-hands or verbal vote. For Role Play, ask for three volunteers to come to the front.
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	Very small room (6–8 people)	Small cohort	All activities run as a single group. Capstone can be done at the table as a group read-aloud with individual written exercise.
☐ TECHNOLOGY	Confirm projector/display, microphone if needed, speaker volume, and click-through device are all working. Test video audio before participants arrive.		
☐ PERSONAL PREP	Read this Facilitator Guide cover to cover at least once. Review all scenario cards and know the facilitator answer keys. Review the Capstone scenario and be ready to guide the debrief without reading from the handout.		
☐ PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY	Review the psychological safety statement in the Training Overview. Be ready to use the reset phrase if a discussion becomes heated or inappropriate.		
☐ CONTINGENCY	Know what to do if a participant discloses a real current situation during training. Review the escalation protocol on the following page.		

Escalation Protocol: If a Participant Discloses a Real Situation

REAL DISCLOSURE DURING TRAINING — WHAT TO DO

Stay calm. Do not dismiss or minimize what was shared.

Acknowledge the courage it took to raise it: "Thank you for sharing that. I want to make sure you have access to the right support."

Do NOT investigate, probe, or ask for additional detail in the room.

Remind the participant of reporting options: HR at 312-751-4443 or the OIG at 312-751-4444.

After the session, notify the HR Employee Relations section immediately — even if the participant says they do not want to report. You have a responsibility to pass this along.

Document the disclosure in your facilitator notes: date, time, what was said, who was present.

TRAINING OVERVIEW

Course Purpose	This training is designed to help all MWRD employees understand their role in creating a respectful, civil, and inclusive workplace. It covers workplace expectations, appropriate conduct, employee responsibilities, and the reporting process under MWRD policy.
Audience	All MWRD employees — operations, administrative, field, and office-based. Mixed audiences are expected and intentional.
Duration	Approximately 2 hours, including a 10-minute break after Module 3.
Modules	Module 1: Welcome & Employee Role Module 2: Harassment, Discrimination & Retaliation Module 3: Civility & Inclusion BREAK Module 4: Social Media Module 5: Reporting Concerns Module 6: Capstone & Reflection
Instructional Strategy	Instructor-led, discussion-based, scenario-driven. Minimal lecture. Learning happens through group discussion, scenario sorting, role play, and the capstone application exercise.
Policies Referenced	AP 10.5.0 (Anti-Harassment, Anti-Discrimination, Anti-Retaliation) AP 10.11.0 (Whistleblower) AP 10.15.0 (Complaint Procedure) AP 10.27.0 (Rules for Employee Conduct) AP 10.44.0 (Social Media)
HR Contact	312-751-4443 — Employee Relations Section
OIG Contact	312-751-4444 inspectorgeneral@mwrdd.org

Psychological Safety Statement

Read at or near the start of the session:

"This training covers topics that may feel close to home for some people. We are going to talk about real workplace behaviors using realistic scenarios. Some of this content may prompt personal reactions, and that is okay.

What we commit to in this room: we engage with the content professionally, we do not use this space to litigate past situations with named colleagues, and we treat each other with the same respect this training is asking us to bring to our teams.

If at any point you need a moment, please take one. If something comes up that requires a private conversation, I am available, and so is HR at 312-751-4443."

Learning Objectives — Slide 3

- Recognize inappropriate workplace behavior
- Understand employee rights and responsibilities under MWRD policy
- Respond appropriately when you experience or witness a workplace concern
- Identify when and how to report concerns internally and externally
- Contribute actively to a respectful, civil, and inclusive workplace

Training Agenda — Slide 2

Module 1 Welcome & Employee Role | ~15 min

Module 2 Harassment, Discrimination & Retaliation | ~30 min

Module 3 Respectful Workplace, Civility & Inclusion | ~30 min

Break 10 minutes

Module 4 Social Media & Inappropriate Conduct | ~12 min

Module 5 Reporting Concerns & Employee Responsibilities | ~25 min

Module 6 Capstone Scenario Lab & Reflection | ~20 min

MODULE 1 | Welcome & Employee Role | Slides 1–6 | ~15 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES
Slides 1–6	TIMING ~15 minutes total.	<i>Tip: Your energy and tone in Module 1 sets the room's energy for the entire session. Warmth + authority.</i>
Pre-Session	MATERIALS Participant Guides, face-down at each seat PPT Slide 1 displayed as participants enter Flip chart or whiteboard with HR number 312-751-4443 posted visibly Sticky notes	

Slide 1	Slide 1 — Introduction TIMING: 2 minutes SAY: Good morning / Good afternoon. Welcome to MWRD's Respect, Civility and Inclusion Training — Employee Edition. My name is [name], and I'll be your facilitator today. Today's session is about the role each of us plays in creating and maintaining a respectful, civil, and inclusive workplace. This session is designed to be discussion-based and scenario-based. This is not a lecture. Your participation and experiences are an important part of the training. We're going to talk about: • What respect and civility look like at work • What harassment, discrimination, and retaliation are • What your responsibilities are as an employee • And what to do if you experience or witness concerning behavior ASK: A Before we get started, quick show of hands. How many of you have attended workplace conduct training before? LEARNERS DO: Raise hands / brief participation. FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Acknowledge experience levels and emphasize this training will be practical and scenario-based. SAY: A few logistics before we begin: [restrooms / emergency exits / device expectations]. We ask that if you need to step out, please do so quietly and return as soon as you can.	<i>Tip: Introduce yourself briefly — name, role. Keep it under 30 seconds. The session is about them, not you.</i> <i>Tip: Stand at the front with good posture. Do not start from behind a table.</i>
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Slide 1	FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Read the Psychological Safety Statement now. SAY: <i>This training covers topics that may feel close to home for some people. We are going to talk about real workplace behaviors using realistic scenarios. Some of this content may prompt personal reactions, and that is okay.</i> <i>What we commit to in this room: we engage with the content professionally, we do not use this space to litigate past situations with named colleagues, and we treat each other with the same respect this training is asking us to bring to our teams.</i> <i>If at any point you need a moment, please take one. If something comes up that requires a private conversation, I am available, and so is HR at 312-751-4443.</i> SAY: <i>Now let's look at what we are covering today and how we are going to spend our time</i> DISPLAY next slide	Caution: Do not rush through this. Read it with intention. Participants who feel unsafe will shut down before you begin. If asked — "Are we going to talk about real situations?" "We use composite scenarios based on real patterns. No individual's situation is under discussion here."
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Slides 2–4	Slides 2 — Agenda TIMING: 1–2 minutes SAY: Here is how our time together is structured today. We have six modules and we will move through them in order. Each one builds on the last, so we are not going to jump around. We'll begin with your role in shaping workplace culture, then move into respectful conduct, policy definitions, social media scenarios, reporting options, and a capstone exercise that brings everything together. There will be a 10-minute break in the middle. This is an interactive session, so expect table discussions, scenario work, and debriefs throughout. A few housekeeping items before we move on: • Attendance will be recorded today. Please make sure your name is on the roster before you leave. • Restrooms are [location]. We will take a formal break after Module 3 but feel free to step out quietly if needed. • Phones on vibrate please. If you need to take an urgent call, step outside. • At the end of the session you will complete an evaluation form. HR asks that you submit it before you leave. • Your Participant Guide is in front of you. It has the policy references, activity worksheets, and a notes section. ASK: Any questions before we move on?	
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FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Take questions if offered. If a question goes deep into content — 'What counts as harassment?' — acknowledge it and redirect: 'Great question — that is exactly what Module 3 covers. Hold that thought.'

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 3 — Training Objectives

TIMING: 1–2 minutes

SAY:

These are the outcomes for today. By the end of the session, you should be able to identify the difference between conduct that is inappropriate, conduct that raises a policy concern, and conduct that must be reported.

You should also leave knowing your role, your options, and your responsibilities when concerns arise. As we move through the training, keep these objectives in mind. They are the thread connecting each module.

ASK:

Before we get started, does anyone have any questions about the purpose of the training or what we'll be covering today?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Pause for questions.

Throughout the training, you may think of questions or situations you're curious about. On your table (or up front), you'll see sticky notes. If you have a question, you can write it on a sticky note and place it on the Parking Lot flip chart. We will review these questions together toward the end of the training to make sure we address them.

Alright, let's start by talking about what respect, civility, and inclusion actually look like in the workplace.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 4 — Why This Matters To You

TIMING: 2-3 minutes

SAY: *Before we go into policy — I want to spend one minute on why this matters to you personally. Your protection. Your team. Early intervention. Your voice. These are the four reasons this is worth two hours of your day.*

It also matters because employees need to know their rights. If something happens, you should know what protections exist, where to go, and what the District expects.

Finally, small issues do not usually stay small when they go unaddressed. A culture is built through repeated behavior, and early action helps prevent more serious

Tip: *Point to each item on Slide 4 as you name it. Slow down on "your voice" — that concept anchors the whole training.*

problems later.

ASK:

Think about the last time something felt off at work — a comment, a situation, an interaction. You do not have to share the details. Just think about it for a second.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Pause — two to three seconds of actual silence.

SAY: That instinct that something was off? That is what we are going to sharpen today.

DISPLAY next slide

Activity 1: What Does Respect Look Like?

TIMING: 5 minutes

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Direct participants to Module 1, Activity 1.

SAY:

Before we get into policies or procedures, I want to start with your real experiences. Take a moment to think about a time at work when you felt genuinely respected by a coworker, a lead, or a supervisor. What did they actually do?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Pause: give them 30 seconds of actual silence.

SAY: Now, at your tables (or in groups —no more than 2 or 3), discuss what made that moment feel different? What behaviors stood out? Be prepared to share your responses with the whole group. You have 1 minute. Let's begin!

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Allow groups 2–3 minutes to discuss. Walk the room and listen for concrete workplace behaviors that participants mention.

SAY:

Now let's flip it. What does a disrespectful workplace feel like? And more importantly, what does it cost a team?

LEARNERS DO:

Discuss at tables for 2–3 minutes. Each table or group identifies one behavior that builds respect, and one behavior that erodes it. Facilitator calls on 3–4 volunteers. There are no wrong answers — this is a warm-up, not a test. As participants respond, write key words and phrases on the flip chart into the two columns.

Tip: Do not accept vague qualities like "respectful" or "kind." Push for the observable behavior: "What did respectful actually look like?"

Caution: If someone shares something that sounds like a current complaint, do not engage it in the group. Note it privately and follow up after.

Common reaction: Groups sometimes struggle to shift from feeling to behavior. Use: "What did they DO — not what kind of person were they?"



Slide 5:
ACTIVITY 1

SAY:

What you just shared is exactly where this starts. Respect in the workplace isn't theoretical. It shows up in everyday behaviors, choices, and interactions.

Everything we cover today, the policies, the scenarios, the reporting procedures — all of it connects back to this. The goal is to help you recognize those moments and respond in a way that supports a respectful, effective workplace.

Let's talk about what your specific role is in making that happen.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 6 — Your Role in a Respectful Workplace

TIMING: 3–4 minutes

SAY:

Look at the flip chart from our opening discussion. You described what a respectful workplace looks like. Now here's the question — who creates that?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Pause for responses. Let them say 'leadership' or 'management.' Validate it, then redirect.

Leadership sets the standard. But culture is built by what everyone does or doesn't do every single day. It's built by what you say to a coworker. It's built by whether you speak up when something feels wrong. It's built by whether you let a comment slide because it didn't happen to you.

 FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Select **Policy AP 10.5.0** and briefly explain that this policy outlines MWRD's expectations related to harassment, discrimination, retaliation, reporting responsibilities, and respectful workplace conduct.

Then select **Policy AP 10.27.0** and explain that this policy focuses more broadly on employee conduct standards and behavioral expectations across the workplace.

Emphasize that these policies will appear throughout the training and serve as the foundation for many of the scenarios, activities, discussions, and reporting decisions participants will work through today.

After briefly reviewing both policy references, return focus to the PPT slide before continuing the discussion.

CLICK AND SAY:

District policy — specifically AP 10.5.0 and AP 10.27.0 — doesn't just tell leadership what to do. It defines expectations for every employee. That means you

***Tip:** Your tone should shift slightly here — still warm, but more direct. You're moving from opening conversation into core policy content.*

Slide 6

are not a bystander in this. You are a participant.

ASK:

Think about a time when someone's behavior — good or bad — changed the dynamic on your team or crew. You don't have to share the details. Just think about the ripple effect of one person's choice."

What happens in a workplace when people consistently look the other way?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief whole-group discussion — 2 to 3 responses.

SAY:

Everything we cover today — harassment, discrimination, reporting, social media — all of it comes back to choices. Your choices. Not just your supervisor's. Yours. Let's look at what those choices look like in practice. Let's get into it. Module 2 — Respectful Workplace, Civility and Inclusion.

DISPLAY next slide

MODULE 2 | Harassment, Discrimination & Retaliation | Slides 7–16 | ~30 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slides 7–16	TIMING ~30 minutes. Includes Activity 2 (video case study, ~8 min).	Caution: Policy accuracy is critical in this module. If you are unsure of any definition, read directly from AP 10.5.0. Do not improvise definitions.

Slides 7	Slides 7— Module 2: Harassment, Discrimination & Retaliation TIMING: 1 minute SAY: Module 2 is the legal and policy core of this training. We are going to define harassment, discrimination, and retaliation specifically, using the language of AP 10.5.0. DISPLAY next slide	Tip: Pause after "pervasive." Most people assume harassment requires one obvious, serious event. The pervasive standard is the teaching point most people miss. Policy source: AP 10.5.0, Section A. Read directly if challenged.
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Slide 8	Slides 8— What is Harassment? SAY: So what is harassment? Let's review AP 10.5.0 together. FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Open Policy AP 10.5.0 and briefly review Section A with participants. SAY: AP 10.5.0 defines harassment as any unwelcome conduct based on a legally protected characteristic that either becomes a condition of employment — that's quid pro quo — or is severe or pervasive enough to create an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment. Two words matter more than anything else here: unwelcome and pervasive. You do not have to object out loud for conduct to be unwelcome. And you do not need one dramatic incident — a pattern of smaller incidents can meet the legal threshold. FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: After reviewing the policy language, toggle back to the PPT slide before beginning the discussion questions. ASK: Where is the line between teasing, inappropriate conduct, and harassment? Can a single incident still violate policy, even if nobody intended harm? LEARNERS DO: Brief discussion. SAY: Intent is not required. Both severity and pervasiveness are pathways. Protected characteristics are broader than most people realize. Policy reference: AP 10.5.0, Section A. DISPLAY next slide	Tip: Keep the policy review brief (1–2 minutes). The goal is not to read the policy word-for-word, but to familiarize participants with where the language lives and reinforce that supervisors and employees are expected to use policy language — not personal interpretation — when evaluating workplace conduct concerns.
Slides 9	Slides 9 — Sexual Harassment Defined Timing: 3 minutes SAY: Sexual harassment has two legal forms. The first is quid pro	<i>[Policy reference: AP 10.5.0, Section A.1]</i>

quo, which we will cover on the next slide. The second is hostile work environment, which is what most of these examples on the right create.

What makes conduct sexual harassment under AP 10.5.0 is that it is unwelcome. Someone laughing along in the moment does not mean the conduct was welcome. Someone not objecting in the moment does not mean the conduct was welcome. The standard is whether a reasonable person would find the conduct hostile or offensive.

One more thing: the policy explicitly states that the working environment is not limited to a physical location. Conduct that happens after hours, on personal devices, or off-site still falls under this policy if it affects the employment relationship.

ASK:

If a coworker says they were just joking and the target laughed, does that mean no harassment occurred?

Can harassment happen between people of the same gender?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief Q&A. Confirm: joking and laughter do not define consent. Same-gender harassment is fully covered under AP 10.5.0.

SAY:

Two forms: quid pro quo and hostile work environment. Unwelcome is the standard. Off-site and off-hours conduct is covered.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 10 — Quid Pro Quo Harassment

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

Quid pro quo harassment is the clearest example of power being misused in a workplace. It does not have to be explicit. A supervisor who says 'I can make things easier for you if we get to know each other better' is engaging in quid pro quo conduct even if no direct threat is made.

What makes this a violation is the combination of authority and the conditioning of employment outcomes on personal compliance. The employee does not have to say yes for a violation to have occurred. The offer or threat alone is sufficient.

One incident. One conversation. That is enough.

Slides 10

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Open **Policy AP 10.5.0, Section A.1.f**, on the MWRD policy portal and briefly review the quid pro quo language with participants. Emphasize that a single offer, threat, or implied exchange tied to workplace benefits or consequences may constitute a policy violation, even if the employee does not comply or formally report it.

After reviewing the policy language, return to the PPT slide before beginning the discussion questions.

ASK:

If a supervisor invites a direct report to dinner to 'discuss a potential promotion,' what concerns does that raise?
Does the employee have to report it for it to be a violation?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief Q&A.; Facilitator confirms: no, the conduct is a violation regardless of whether the employee reports it or complies.

SAY:

This is why we say: report it immediately. Not when you are sure. Not when you have evidence. When it happens.

DISPLAY next slide

[Policy reference: AP 10.5.0, Section A.1.f.]

Slide 11 — What is Discrimination?

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

This definition is important and I want to spend a moment on it before we go to the examples.

The prior definition of discrimination many of us have heard is simply: treating someone differently because of a protected characteristic. That definition is incomplete because it assumes an even playing field. It does not account for context.

This definition does three things. It names the injustice explicitly. It extends to socially protected characteristics, not only legally defined ones. And it anchors individual treatment decisions to historical and structural context. That context matters because it is why some programs and policies designed to increase equity for historically underrepresented groups are not discrimination. They are correction.

AP 10.5.0 lists specific forms of discrimination. Let's look at what those include.

***Tip:** "Unintentional discrimination" is often new information for participants. Give it a moment to land before moving on.*

Slide 11

ASK:

What is the difference between differential treatment and discriminatory treatment?

Can unintentional conduct still be discrimination under this policy?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief Q&A. Confirm: yes, AP 10.5.0 explicitly covers unintentional discrimination. Intent is relevant to discipline but not to whether a violation occurred.

SAY:

Context is part of the definition. Unintentional conduct can be discrimination. Equity-focused programs are not discrimination — they are correction. Policy reference: AP 10.5.0, Section B.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 12 — What is Retaliation?

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

Retaliation is the reason people do not report. And it is real. The policy protects against it specifically. But protection only works if people recognize retaliation when it is happening. Retaliation is not always obvious. Many employees expect retaliation to look extreme, such as termination or demotion, but it is often much more subtle.

Employees may notice:

- coworkers suddenly avoiding them
- being left out of meetings
- increased criticism
- communication becoming cold or dismissive
- schedule or responsibility changes without explanation

These changes may happen after:

- reporting harassment or discrimination
- participating in an investigation
- supporting another employee's complaint
- raising concerns in good faith

Employees do not need proof before reporting concerns. If behavior changes after a protected activity and it feels

Caution: If a participant starts describing a current situation with names, interrupt gently: "Let's keep our examples general here, but I'd encourage you to connect with HR after the session."

Tip: Accept 2–3 responses to the discussion question and then move on. This is a priming question, not a testimony session.

Slide 12

retaliatory, employees should document concerns and report them through the appropriate channels.

Take, for instance, an employee reports harassment. A week later, coworkers stop including them in lunch meetings and team discussions.

ASK:

Why might this feel retaliatory?

What should the employee do?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Invite 1–2 participants to respond. Emphasize that sudden criticism following a protected activity may create the perception of retaliation.

SAY:

The standard for reporting retaliation is not proof. It is the experience of adverse treatment following a protected activity. Report the pattern. Let HR investigate the connection. Please refer to Policy AP 10.5.0, Section C for more information.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 13 — Intent vs. Impact

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

I want to pause on this concept because it is where most people push back in training. They say: but I did not mean anything by it. And that may be completely true.

Here is what the law and District policy say about that: intent is relevant to how seriously we discipline. It is not relevant to whether a violation occurred. If the conduct was unwelcome and based on a protected characteristic, it is a violation. Full stop.

This is not meant to make people feel like they are walking on eggshells. It is meant to shift the focus from what I meant to how I can communicate in a way that does not create that impact in the first place.

ASK:

Common reaction: *"That seems unfair." — "It's a higher standard than most people expect. But it protects people who can't prove intent while experiencing real harm."*

Caution: Do not qualify this with "of course intent matters a little." In policy terms, intent does not determine a violation. Keep the standard clean.

Slide 13

Why does the law use the reasonable person standard rather than the subjective experience of the individual?

How does this change how you think about your own behavior at work?

SAY:

Good intent is worth noting. It is not worth defending. The person who experienced the conduct still experienced it. And it is still your responsibility to understand that impact and adjust.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 14 — Employee & Supervisor Responsibilities

TIMING: 2 minutes

SAY:

The legal definition of harassment has two key requirements. First, the conduct must be based on a legally protected characteristic. Second, it must be either a condition of employment or severe and pervasive enough to create a hostile environment.

Notice what is not in that definition: intent. The law does not require that the person meant to harass anyone. What matters is the effect on the person experiencing it.

The list of protected characteristics is broader than most people realize. If conduct targets or demeans someone because of any of these characteristics, it falls under this policy.

ASK:

What is the difference between teasing and harassment under this definition?

Can something be harassment even if only one person experienced it?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief Q&A. Confirm: yes, isolated severe incidents can be harassment. Frequency and severity are both pathways.

SAY:

Intent is not required. Both severity and pervasiveness are pathways. Protected characteristics are broader than most

Mixed audiences: If, for some reason, supervisors are present, call out their obligation directly: "Supervisors in this room, if you learn of possible violations, your obligation to report is mandatory."

Slide 14

people realize. Policy reference: AP 10.5.0, Section A.

DISPLAY next slide



Activity 2: Video Case Study

Confirm audio is working BEFORE advancing to this slide.

TIMING: 10 minutes

SAY:

We just looked at the definitions of harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. Now, we are going to watch a scenario where these lines get blurred. Your job is not to judge the characters in the video. Your job is to observe and analyze using everything we have covered so far.

After the video, your table will have five minutes to discuss the four questions on screen. Then we will debrief as a group.

Here we go.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

PLAY VIDEO: Do not narrate over the video. Let it play completely before speaking. Allow one beat of silence after it ends before calling time and directing tables/groups to discuss.

LEARNERS DO:

Watch the video silently. After video: table discussion for **5 minutes** using the four questions on screen.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Facilitator circulates and listens. Note which tables identify the issues correctly and which do not — use those observations in the debrief.

DISPLAY next slide.

Caution: If video fails: do NOT skip this activity. Use the verbal fallback:

"Carmen learns she was not selected for a project lead opportunity. When she asks why, her supervisor tells her another employee was a 'better cultural fit' and reminds her that she has been 'making things complicated' since raising a prior scheduling concern. A coworker nearby overhears the conversation, including the warning about how Carmen is 'seen around here.' Afterward, the coworker approaches Carmen privately, validates what she heard, and encourages her to contact the HR Department."



Slide 15:
ACTIVITY 2

Activity 2 Debrief — Table Discussion then Group Share-Out

ASK: "What specific behaviors did you observe in the video?"

ASK: "What type of conduct was this — harassment, discrimination, retaliation, or inappropriate behavior?"

ASK: "What should Carmen have done in that moment?"

Expected analysis: Conduct = hostile work environment / possible retaliation. Carmen's options: inform the coworker the conduct is unwelcome (her right), report to HR.

Witness: the right — not requirement — to speak up. Good-faith reports are protected.

Tip: If group identifies everything quickly, push deeper: "What if Carmen had laughed

ASK: "If you were the coworker who witnessed this, what are your options under AP 10.5.0?"

DISPLAY next slide.

it off? Does that change the analysis?" —
Answer: No. Unwelcome conduct is evaluated based on impact and context — not whether someone immediately objects or reacts visibly.

Witnesses may choose to speak up directly, but regardless of whether they intervene in the moment, employees can still report concerns in good faith under District policy.

Slide 16

Slide 16 — Module 2 Key Takeaways

TIMING: 1 min

SAY: "Three key takeaways. All three categories — harassment, discrimination, and retaliation — are prohibited under AP 10.5.0."

SAY: "Intent does not determine a violation. Impact and the reasonable person standard do."

SAY: "When in doubt, report. You are not being asked to investigate or determine whether a violation occurred. HR does that. You are being asked to report the concern."

DISPLAY next slide.

Tip: Say these three takeaways in your own words, not as a list read from the slide. These are the anchor points for the rest of the training.

MODULE 3 | Respectful Workplace, Civility & Inclusion | Slides 17–26 | ~30 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slides 17–26	TIMING ~30 minutes. Activity 3 (Spectrum Sort) is the centerpiece — allocate at least 15 minutes.	Tip: Do not rush Slides 18–21. Participants need the conceptual foundation before the scenario sort will work well.

Slides 17

Slides 17 — Module 3: Introduction

TIMING: 1 minute

SAY:

We are moving into Module 3 now. In this module, we will review what respect and civility actually look like in practice, where the lines are, and how communication either builds or breaks down trust on a team.

Most people in this room already know how to treat people

with respect. That is not what this module is testing. What we are going to do is sharpen your ability to recognize behavior on a spectrum, including behavior that seems small but is not, and behavior that is common but not acceptable.

We are going to do this together. There is an activity in this module where your table is going to make some judgment calls. Some of them will be easy. Some of them will not. The disagreements are the point.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 18 — Respect Is Not a Feeling. It Is a Behavior.

SAY: "Respect is not a personality trait. It is a behavior — observable, measurable, and a daily decision. Slide 18 shows what it looks like and what it does not look like."

SAY: "Notice that some of the 'does not look like' behaviors are not policy violations. They are still problems. They erode trust and make it unsafe for people to do their best work."

ASK: "Looking at the right column — which of these do you see most often in your experience?"

Tip: Take 2–3 answers, then move on. This is a warm-up for the spectrum concept. Do not let it become a venting session.

Caution: If someone names a specific person, redirect: "Let's keep this general — we're thinking about patterns, not individuals."

Slides 18

Slide 19— The Behavioral Gap

TIMING: 5 minutes

SAY:

Most people in this room would describe themselves as respectful. And I believe that. So here is the question worth sitting with: if we all intend to be respectful, why does disrespect still happen so often?

The answer is the behavioral gap. Intent is invisible. Behavior is what other people experience. You can mean well and still say something that lands the wrong way. You can think you are being direct and someone else hears dismissiveness.

Before we talk through what creates that gap, I want you to hear it first. We are going to listen to a short conversation between two coworkers. Their names are Hope and Judith. One of them is a manager. I want you to listen for the gap. Not what is said. What is felt.

LEARNERS DO:

Tell participants before playing:

Slide 19 audio: Per PPT notes, Slide 19 has an audio icon — do not remove it. Confirm audio works. If it fails, narrate the concept directly.

Tip: Read the Slide 21 quote slowly. Let there be silence after it. It is one of the most important sentences in the training. Do not fill the space.

Slides 19

As you listen, think about this one question: where does the gap show up? You do not need to write anything down. Just listen.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:



PLAY AUDIO: Hope and Judith conversation. **File:** **Hope_and_Judith_Employee_edition.mp3**. Duration approximately 1 minute 6 seconds. Ensure audio is queued and volume is set before advancing to this slide. Do not narrate over the audio. Let it play completely before speaking.

ASK:

Where did you hear the gap?

What was the intent of the person speaking? What was the impact on the person receiving it?

Did anything in that conversation feel familiar?

SAY:

That is the behavioral gap. One person thought they were being direct. Maybe even helpful. The other person experienced something entirely different. No malice. No obvious policy violation. Just a gap between what was meant and what landed.

That gap is where most workplace culture problems start. Not at the obvious end of the spectrum. Right here in the middle, in conversations that happen every day.

The gap does not close itself. It closes when we pay attention to impact, not just intention.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 20 — The Spectrum of Workplace Behavior

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

Here is what I want you to understand before we do the sorting activity. Behavior is not just acceptable or unacceptable.

It exists on a spectrum. And the most dangerous place on that spectrum is not the obvious end. It is the middle.

Because in the middle is where behavior gets normalized. A comment here, a tone there, an eye roll in a meeting. None

Slides 20

of those things are going to trigger a formal complaint on their own. But they compound. Over time, they create an environment where people do not feel safe, do not speak up, and eventually stop contributing.

That is what we mean by the spectrum. And that is why we are going to sort some behaviors together in a few minutes.

ASK:

Where on this spectrum do you think most workplace issues start?

What makes the middle of the spectrum more dangerous than the obvious end?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief discussion. Participants point to or name positions on the spectrum. 2 minutes maximum before transitioning to the activity.

SAY:

Most workplace culture problems begin in the inappropriate and policy concern zones, not in the hostile or illegal zone.

By the time behavior reaches the legal threshold, damage has already been done.

The goal is to recognize and address behavior before it escalates.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 21 — Behaviors that Build/Erodes

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

The left column is not a list of heroic acts. It is a list of choices. Choices that are available to everyone in this room, every single day.

The right column is the same. None of those things require malicious intent. Interrupting someone repeatedly. Letting a comment go without addressing it. Sending a message in a tone you would not use face-to-face. These are habits. And habits build culture.

Here is the one I want to make sure we address directly: 'it's so small it doesn't count.' That belief is how workplace culture erodes. Small things count. They count to the person on the

Slides 21

receiving end. They count when they happen consistently. And they count in the pattern they establish over time.

ASK:

What is one behavior from the erode column you have seen go unaddressed on a team?

What keeps people from addressing small behaviors before they escalate?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief whole-group discussion. 1 to 2 responses. Transition immediately to activity instructions after debrief.

SAY:

The 'so small it doesn't count' belief is the single most common reason workplace culture erodes gradually rather than suddenly. Every behavior that gets normalized sets the floor for what follows.

Now you are going to sort some behaviors yourselves. Let's look at the activity.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 22 — Activity 3: Workplace Behavior Spectrum Sort

Distribute one set of Scenario Cards and table tent cards per table/group now.

SAY: Your table will receive a set of four scenario cards. Read each scenario and sort it into one of three categories: Appropriate, Possible Policy Concern, or Must Be Reported. Some of these will feel obvious. Some will not. The ones your table disagrees about are the most valuable ones. Do not resolve the disagreement by compromise. Hold it. You will bring it to the debrief.

You have five minutes. Go

LEARNERS DO:

Each table has a set of four scenario cards and four category tent cards. Groups read each scenario, discuss, and physically place the scenario card in front of the matching tent card. Facilitator circulates, listens, and notes where tables land differently from each other. After 8 minutes, give a 2-minute warning and ask each table to lock in their final verdicts before the debrief slide.

Caution: Do NOT give hints or confirm answers during the sort. Uncertainty is intentional — participants must sit with ambiguity before the debrief resolves it.



Slide 22:
ACTIVITY 3

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

While circulating, specifically listen for tables debating the line between Inappropriate or Uncivil and Policy Concern — that boundary is the most important teaching moment in this deck and will come up on Card 1 and Card 4. Also note any table that calls Card 2 a Policy Concern or Must Be Reported. That is your signal to spend extra time on the performance management vs. harassment distinction in the debrief. Do not correct tables during the sort. Let the disagreements live until the next slide.

MATERIALS NEEDED:

One set of four scenario cards per table · One set of four category tent cards per table · Participant guide open to the scenario reference page.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 23 — Activity 3 Debrief

ASK: "Which scenario was hardest to categorize? Why?"

ASK: "Where did your table disagree internally?"

ASK: "Which behaviors did you almost put in the wrong category?"

ASK: "For the Must Be Reported cards — what policy applies?"

ASK: "What would it take for an Inappropriate behavior to become a Policy Concern?"

SAY: "Let me walk through the key teaching point for each card."

SAY: "Card 1 — Just How We Talk: Devon not speaking up does not make the behavior acceptable. Unwelcome is the standard under AP 10.5.0 — not whether someone objected, laughed, or said nothing. Culture is not a defense."

SAY: "Card 2 — My Supervisor Is Out to Get Me: This is performance management — direct, professional, no protected characteristic involved. Accountability is not harassment. The analysis changes if the supervisor is treating this employee differently on the basis of a protected characteristic."

SAY: "Card 3 — The Eye Roll: Nonverbal conduct can absolutely be a workplace problem. However, as described, no protected characteristic is involved — so this is AP 10.27.0 territory, inappropriate conduct, not AP 10.5.0 harassment. That distinction matters."

Answer key:

- Card 1: MUST BE REPORTED — AP 10.5.0 hostile environment. Culture is not a defense.
- Card 2: APPROPRIATE — performance management, not harassment. Most commonly misread card.
- Card 3: INAPPROPRIATE / UNCIVIL — no protected characteristic named. Category changes if pattern targets a specific identity group.

Caution: Do not give answers before hearing from tables. The learning happens when participants argue for their position first.

Tip: Card 2 generates the most misreads. Spend time here — this misconception drives the most false complaints in workplaces.

Slide 23:
ACTIVITY 3
DEBRIEF

Slides 24 — Communication as a Tool for Respect

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

Communication is the mechanism through which respect either shows up or does not. You can believe in respectful treatment and still communicate in a way that signals disrespect. Tone, timing, and medium all carry meaning.

One of the most common failures in workplace communication is the assumption that because they know what they meant, the other person received it that way. That assumption is the behavioral gap showing up again.

And in digital communication, that gap widens because tone is stripped away entirely. What you type and what someone reads are not always the same message.

ASK:

What communication habit do you think is most commonly misread in your workplace?

What is one thing you could change in how you communicate digitally that would reduce misunderstanding?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief discussion. 1 to 2 responses.

SAY:

Communication is where respect becomes visible. Tone, timing, and medium all carry meaning. Digital communication removes tone, increasing the risk of misreading.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 25 — This vs. That: Communication in Practice

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

These are not scripts. They are patterns. The pattern on the left signals defensiveness, dismissiveness, or escalation. The pattern on the right signals openness, accountability, and professionalism. The most important thing I want you to take from this slide: you do not have to be kind to be professional. You have to be clear. You have to be direct. And you have to leave the other person with their dignity. That is what civil communication looks like. And it is a choice, every time.

Tip: "Obviously" tends to generate the best responses — people recognize it from their own communication. Let 1–2 participants answer before moving on.

ASK:

Which of these swaps do you think is hardest to make in a high-pressure moment?

What gets in the way of communicating the way we know we should?

LEARNERS DO:

Table discussion: 2 minutes. Each table picks the swap they think is hardest to make and shares one reason why. Quick report-out.

SAY:

The hardest moment to communicate professionally is when we are frustrated, tired, or feel wronged. Those are exactly the moments that define how others experience us. This is what Module 2 has been about. Not policy. Behavior. Observable, daily, chosen behavior.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 26 — Module 3 Key Takeaways

TIMING: 2 minutes

SAY:

Three things I want you to hold onto as we move forward.

First: Respect is behavioral. Not a feeling, not an attitude. A choice you make in every interaction.

Second: Behavior is a spectrum. The dangerous zone is not the obvious end. It is the middle, where things get normalized.

Third: Communication is where respect lives in practice. The how matters as much as the what.

ASK: *Are there any questions about anything we covered in Module 3?*

DISPLAY next slide

Timing: 10 minutes

SAY:

Slide 26

BREAK:
10 min

During break: Collect and set aside Scenario Cards. Reset your energy. Refill water if available

Let's take a 10 minute break. When we come back, we will review Module 4 which covers social media conduct. Enjoy your break. See you in ten minutes.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Fill in the "Returning at" time before advancing to this slide. Confirm attendance before participants leave their seats.

Advance to Module 4 title card when the break ends. Do not wait for everyone to settle before advancing.

DISPLAY next slide

MODULE 4 | Social Media & Inappropriate Conduct | Slides 28–31 | ~12 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slides 28–31	TIMING ~12 minutes. Discussion-embedded. No standalone activity.	<i>Tip: Lower intensity after the break — use it to rebuild momentum before Module 5.</i>

Slides 28	Slides 28 — Module 4: Introduction TIMING: 1 minute SAY: Welcome back. Module 4 focuses on social media conduct and the impact online behavior can have on the workplace, coworkers, and professional responsibilities — even outside of work hours. DISPLAY next slide	<i>If asked — "What about my private account?"</i> "Privacy settings are not protection. Once content exists digitally, it can be shared. The question is not whether others can see it — it's whether the content impacts the workplace."
Slides 29	Slides 29 — Social Media and Your Role as an MWRD Employee TIMING: 4 minutes SAY: AP 10.44.0 answers a question a lot of employees have: does what I post on my own account on my own time actually matter at work? The answer is yes. When your post references the District, your colleagues, or District operations, it enters the professional sphere regardless of the platform or the time.	

The most important thing I want you to understand about this policy: privacy settings are not protection. Friends-only posts can be screenshotted. Private messages can be forwarded. Once content exists digitally, it can travel.

And LinkedIn is not a safe harbor because it is professional. In fact, LinkedIn is higher stakes because your MWRD affiliation is displayed by default in your profile. A critical post on LinkedIn connects directly back to the organization in a way that a personal Facebook post often does not.

ASK:

What is the most common misconception employees have about social media and their employer?

Why does LinkedIn carry more professional risk than a personal Facebook post?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief Q&A; 1 to 2 responses.

SAY:

The core principle: your online presence as an MWRD employee is part of your professional conduct. The same standards apply.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 30 — When Social Media Becomes a Workplace Issue

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

Let me give you the test that AP 10.44.0 effectively establishes. Ask yourself: would this post, if seen by a District stakeholder, a member of the public, or a journalist, reflect on MWRD in a way that would concern HR or leadership? If yes, it may cross the line.

The challenge is that many posts that cross the line do not feel like policy violations when people write them. A frustrated comment about management feels like venting. A photo from inside the plant feels like showing pride in your work. Context and platform change the impact entirely.

We are going to test this directly in the activity coming up.

***Tip:** Accept 2 responses and bridge to key takeaways. This question usually generates real examples — keep it general.*

Slide 30

ASK:

At what point does venting on social media become a policy concern?

Why does a photo of a pump station interior create a risk that a photo of the parking lot does not?

LEARNERS DO:

Brief discussion. 1 to 2 responses. Transition directly into Screenshot Deliberation instructions.

SAY:

The most instructive social media cases are the ones where intent was good. Pride in the work. Frustration with a real problem. Good intent does not erase the policy impact.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 31 — Module 4 Key Takeaways

TIMING: 1 minutes

SAY:

Three things from Module 4.

One: off-duty does not mean off the record. Two: privacy settings are not protection. Three: a concerning post may signal two separate issues that both need follow-up.

DISPLAY next slide

***Tip:** Point out explicitly that Module 5 answers: "OK, so I think something happened. What do I actually do?" Name that before you advance.*

MODULE 5 | Reporting Concerns & Employee Responsibilities | Slides 32–39 | ~25 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slides 32–39	TIMING ~25 minutes. Activity 5 (Role Play) = ~10 minutes.	Priority: Participants leaving without the HR number and the reporting threshold is a failure condition. Verbalize both at least twice.
Slides 32		Expected responses:

Slides 32 — Module 5: Introduction

TIMING: 1 minute

SAY:

Module 5 is about reporting. This is the module that matters most to HR and to the District from a legal accountability standpoint.

We are going to cover when to report, how to report internally and externally, the AP 10.15.0 complaint process, and what protections you have when you do report.

There is an activity in this module called Report It or Not. Your table will work through a set of scenarios and decide how to route each concern.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 33 — When to Report

TIMING: 3 minutes

SAY:

The most important thing I want you to take from this slide: the threshold for reporting is not certainty. It is concern.

A lot of people do not report because they think they need evidence. Or they think it needs to be serious enough. Or they do not want to get anyone in trouble. None of those are the right framework. Something happened that may violate this policy. Report it. HR investigates. They determine the rest.

AP 10.5.0 is explicit: chain-of-command approval is not required. You contact Employee Relations directly.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Open Policy AP 10.5.0 (Internal Reporting Procedures) on the MWRD policy portal and briefly review the reporting language with participants. Emphasize that the reporting threshold is concern, not certainty, proof, or evidence. Reinforce that employees may report directly to Employee Relations without chain-of-command approval. After briefly reviewing the policy language, return to the PPT slide before beginning the discussion questions.

Ask:

What are the most common reasons employees do not report concerns at work?

What would it take to remove one of those barriers?

Fear of retaliation. Not wanting to be seen as a troublemaker. Uncertainty about whether it "qualifies." Not knowing the process.

Tip: After responses: "Every one of those reasons is real and understandable. And every one of them is addressed by AP 10.5.0. Let me show you how."

Expected responses:

Fear of retaliation. Not wanting to be seen as a troublemaker. Uncertainty about whether it "qualifies." Not knowing the process.

Tip: After responses: "Every one of those reasons is real and understandable. And every one of them is addressed by AP 10.5.0. Let me show you how."

Slides 33

SAY:

The barriers to reporting are real. The cost of not reporting is higher. When concerns go unreported, behavior gets normalized, more people are affected, and the District loses the ability to address problems early.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 34 — How to Report: Internal Channels

TIMING: 2 minutes

SAY:

This slide covers your two main internal reporting channels, and they are not the same thing, so pay attention to which one applies.

The first is the HR Department. That number is 312-751-4443. This is the channel for harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and workplace conduct concerns. You can call, walk in, email, or write a letter. You can report on your own behalf or as a witness. What matters is that it gets made.

The second is the Office of the Inspector General (the OIG). The OIG is an independent office.

 FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Open AP 10.11.0, Whistleblower and Anti-Retaliation Procedures. Reinforce that employees may report concerns directly to the Office of the Inspector General for matters involving improper governmental activity, including fraud, corruption, bribery, misuse of District property, and related concerns.

SAY:

Their number is 312-751-4444 and their email is inspectorgeneral@mwr.org. The OIG handles a different category of concerns: fraud, corruption, bribery, misuse of District property — what the policy calls improper governmental activity. The OIG also accepts anonymous complaints.

ASK:

Are there any questions about how to use this number or what happens when you call the HR Department?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Take genuine questions here. This is one of the two most practically important slides in the training. If someone asks what happens after they call, confirm: HR will conduct an investigation, maintain confidentiality to the extent possible, and determine whether a violation occurred. The caller does not need to

Caution: Do not let participants leave without the HR number. Say it aloud at least twice. Write it on the flip chart.

If asked — "Can I report anonymously?"

"The OIG accepts anonymous reports. HR reports can sometimes be made without disclosing your identity. When in doubt, call HR at 312-751-4443 and ask what your options are."

Slide 34

provide proof — only a concern.

DISPLAY next slide

Slides 35 — External Channels

TIMING: 2 minutes

SAY:

You have the right to file with any of these agencies at any time. You do not need to exhaust the internal process first. You do not need permission from your supervisor. You do not need to tell HR you are filing externally.

Slides 35

AP 10.5.0 states that investigations will proceed internally regardless of whether an external complaint is filed. External filing is a right, not an escalation.

ASK:

Why might someone choose to file externally in addition to reporting internally?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

1 response then move to the next slide.

DISPLAY next slide

***Tip:** The distinction between AP 10.15.0 and AP 10.5.0 is commonly confused. Repeat it simply: "General workplace complaints: AP 10.15.0. Harassment, discrimination, retaliation: call HR at 312-751-4443."*

Slides 36 — The Complaint Process

TIMING: 5 minutes

SAY:

AP 10.15.0 outlines the District's formal complaint procedure for non-represented employees who want to appeal or address employment-related concerns through a structured chain-of-command process. This process is different from the reporting pathway used for harassment, discrimination, retaliation, or other protected-conduct concerns, which are handled directly through the HR Department under AP 10.5.0. Using the correct reporting pathway helps ensure concerns are reviewed appropriately and addressed as efficiently as possible.

Slides 36



FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Open AP 10.15.0 and orient participants to the structure of the complaint process. Point out that each appeal step includes a seven-calendar-day submission window and a corresponding seven-day response timeline.

Emphasize that:

- this is a formal appeal pathway for employment-related concerns
- the process follows the chain of command
- harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and protected-conduct concerns should instead be directed to HR Employee Relations under AP 10.5.0

After reviewing the policy structure, return to the PPT slide before beginning the animation sequence.

CLICK AND SAY:

Step 1 begins with the employee submitting a written complaint to their immediate supervisor within seven calendar days of the event or concern. The supervisor must then respond within seven calendar days. This is the starting point for most employment-related concerns covered under AP 10.15.0.

CLICK AND SAY:

If the concern is not resolved at Step 1, the employee may appeal to the Department Head within seven calendar days of receiving the supervisor's response. The Department Head then has seven calendar days to respond. Notice that the timelines continue at every level of the process.

CLICK AND SAY:

If the concern is still unresolved, the employee may submit a Step 3 appeal to the Director of Human Resources within seven calendar days of the Step 2 response. At this level, HR reviews the complaint and issues a final decision under Personnel Rule 12.01.

CLICK AND SAY:

In some cases, there may be an optional final appeal step through the Civil Service Board under Personnel Rule 12.01. Not every complaint reaches this stage, but employees should understand that this option exists within the formal process.

ASK:

Before I move on, can anyone give me an example of the type of concern this process would cover? What kinds of workplace situations would go through AP 10.15.0 rather than AP 10.5.0?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTION:

Take 2 to 3 responses. If participants answer correctly, affirm and build on their examples

SAY:

The seven-calendar-day timelines are important. If you have a concern, do not wait. And when you are unsure which process applies, contact HR for guidance before moving forward.

DISPLAY next slide

***Tip:** If responses are vague, off-track, or the group is quiet, offer the following:*

"Here are a few examples: being asked to work outside of your job"

classification, appealing a verbal or written warning, a demotion or denial of a promotion, or a scheduling or workload dispute. These are general employment concerns and not protected-class issues. The moment race, sex, age, disability, religion, or another protected characteristic enters the picture, you are in AP 10.5.0 territory and HR Employee Relations is your channel."

Slide 37 — Confidentiality and Non-Retaliation Protections

TIMING: 1 minute

SAY: Your report will be kept confidential to the greatest extent possible. HR will not broadcast who filed a complaint. If HR needs to share information to conduct a thorough investigation, they may, but disclosure is limited to what the investigation requires.

SAY: If you experience retaliation after reporting: document the adverse change, report it separately to HR immediately, and let HR make the connection. Your job is to report the pattern, not to prove it.

SAY: The quote on this slide is real: 'Silence in the face of retaliation is not self-protection. It is the opposite.'

DISPLAY next slide

If asked — "What if my supervisor finds out I reported them?"

"Your supervisor will not receive the details of your report. HR notifies the chain of command that a report is in process — not the specifics. Any action taken against you for reporting is itself a policy violation."

Slide 38 — Activity 5: What Would You Say? Role Play

TIMING: 8 minutes

SAY:

This is a role play. Keep it realistic and conversational. Your goal is not to solve the situation. Your goal is to support your colleague and help them think through what to do next.

Observers, you are watching for what helps and what might unintentionally shut the conversation down.

Take 30 seconds to assign roles, then get started.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Circulate and do not intervene unless a group is completely off track.

Listen for:

Responder jumping too quickly to advice

Missed opportunity to name reporting options

Language that minimizes or discourages reporting

At 5 minutes, call time. Give Observers 2 minutes to lead a quick table debrief.

SAY: *Observers, lead your table debrief for 2 minutes. Start with what the Responder did well.*

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Allow 2 minutes of table debrief. Then bring the group back.

Activity 5 Debrief

ASK:

Let's come back together. Observers, what did you hear the Responder say that actually helped the Reporter move forward?

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Take 2 to 3 responses. If answers are vague, prompt: "What exactly did they say? What made that effective?"

ASK:

Responders: what was the hardest part? What did you want to say that you knew you should not?

ASK:

Did the Responder name a specific reporting option? If not, what should they have said?

ASK:

If the Reporter had walked away after this conversation, would she have

Listen for: Responder listening first vs. jumping to solution. Responder naming HR (312-751-4443) specifically. Responder addressing the Reporter's fear of making things worse. Reporter knowing what to do next at the end.



Slide 38:
ACTIVITY 5

known what to do next?

SAY:

In these situations, your role is not to investigate or solve the issue. It is to do three things: listen, acknowledge what you are hearing, and help the person understand their options. One clear, supportive response can make the difference between someone speaking up or staying silent.

DISPLAY next slide

Slide 39

Slide 39 — Module 5 Key Takeaways

TIMING: 1 minute

SAY: Concern is the threshold — not certainty, not proof. Know the numbers: HR at 312-751-4443, OIG at 312-751-4444. Know which process applies: AP 10.5.0 for harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. AP 10.15.0 for other workplace concerns. Lastly, when in doubt, call HR.

DISPLAY next slide

***Tip:** Say the HR number one more time before transitioning. Repetition is intentional — it is the most actionable piece of information in this training.*

MODULE 6 | Capstone Scenario Lab & Reflection | Slides 40–43 | ~20 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slides 40–43	TIMING ~20 minutes total: 4 min read + 8 min reporting exercise + 5 min debrief + 3 min reflection.	Caution: If running behind, cut reflection time to 2 minutes. Do NOT cut the capstone application. It is the most critical exercise in the training.

Slide 40	Slide 40 — Module 6: Introduction TIMING: 1 minute SAY: Module 6 is the final module. We have 15 minutes and two things to do. First, a capstone scenario — your small group will receive a scenario that pulls content from every module today. Second, a personal commitment — you are going to leave today with one specific thing you are committing to do differently. FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS: Do not open discussion. Advance immediately. DISPLAY next slide	
 CAPSTONE ACTIVITY	Slide 41 — Capstone Scenario Lab: "The Situation on Crew 4" SAY: This capstone brings together everything we've covered. One scenario that touches multiple policies, multiple behaviors, and requires you to apply what you know — not just recognize it. Open your Participant Guide to the Capstone section. SAY: Part 1: Read the scenario individually and silently. Four minutes. Identify the conduct types, the protected characteristics involved, and the red flags. SAY: Part 2: Complete the Reporting Exercise on your own. Eight minutes. Prepare your notes as if you are about to call HR. Use only the facts in	Caution: Do not read the scenario aloud. Do not summarize it. Participants must engage with it individually first. Tip: During Part 2, the <i>Retaliation Flag</i> section is often the most revealing. Note whether participants identify Frank's threat correctly.

the scenario.

SAY:

Part 3: Large-group debrief — I'll lead that. Start Part 1 now. Go.

LEARNERS DO:

Silent reading (4 minutes).

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Do not circulate or prompt. Let participants think.

LEARNERS DO:

Part 2: 8 minutes of individual writing.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Circulate quietly. Note what people write on the Retaliation Flag section.

Capstone Debrief — Large Group, Facilitator-Led

ASK:

What conduct did you identify in this scenario?

ASK:

What protected characteristics are involved? Take a moment — there are more than one.

ASK:

Darnell says he does not want to make a formal complaint. Does that change what you do?

SAY:

Key answer: Under AP 10.5.0, even if an employee asks you not to report, you have a strong responsibility to act on what you know. As an employee, not a supervisor, you still have the right to report. And the facts you have are significant.

ASK:

Frank's statement to Darnell 'If you go crying to HR about this, everyone on this crew is going to know you can't handle the job.' What is that?

SAY:

That is a retaliation threat. AP 10.5.0, Section C. Must be documented separately and reported to HR immediately — independent of the underlying complaint.

Behaviors in scenario:

- Frank's pattern of comments = potential hostile work environment (AP 10.5.0 — religion/political identity).
- Hijab comment to Amara = religious discrimination + hostile environment (AP 10.5.0).
- Group text meme = social media violation + potential harassment (AP 10.44.0 + AP 10.5.0).
- Facebook post = AP 10.44.0 violation.
- Frank's retaliation threat = AP 10.5.0, Section C — document separately.
- Carmen's inaction = supervisor obligation failure under AP 10.5.0.

**CAPSTONE
DEBRIEF**

ASK:

The Facebook post. Frank posted from a personal account, off the clock. Does that matter?

SAY: No. AP 10.44.0 applies. The post was public, his profile listed MWRD, and the content targeted coworkers based on protected characteristics. This is a workplace issue.

ASK: Carmen overheard a comment two weeks ago and Amara reported to her. Nothing happened. How does that affect the analysis?

Caution: If participants try to adjudicate who is "right," redirect: "Our job is not to investigate — it's to decide what to do with what we know. What are the facts? What does policy require?"

Slide 42 — Reflection

SAY:

Three minutes. Open your Participant Guide to the Reflection page. Three prompts. This page is yours — you keep it. You will not be asked to share it.



REFLECTION

LEARNERS DO:

3 minutes of silent reflection.

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS:

Do not narrate. Stand or sit quietly.

Tip: Silence is uncomfortable here for facilitators. Resist the urge to fill it. These 3 minutes produce more behavior change than another 10 minutes of content.

CLOSING | Slide 43 | ~3 minutes

SLIDE	FACILITATOR	NOTES (for facilitator only)
Slide 43	Slide 43 — Thank You SAY: Before I let you go — I want to close with what's on this last slide, because I mean it. SAY: Every employee who completes this training, takes it seriously, and carries it back to their team makes MWRD stronger, safer, and more equitable. That's not a tagline. That's how culture actually changes — through people making different choices in the moments that matter. SAY: You now know the policies. You know the reporting numbers — HR at 312-751-	Caution: Stay in the room for at least 5–10 minutes after dismissal. Participants who want to raise a real situation will often wait for others to leave. Post-session: Complete your Facilitator Notes within 24 hours: date, location, attendance, notable reactions, any disclosures requiring follow-up.

4443, OIG at 312-751-4444. You know the threshold for reporting. And you know what respect looks like as a behavior, not a feeling. That is enough to make a difference.

SAY: Thank you for your time and engagement today. If anything came up for you during this training that you'd like to talk through privately, I'm available now or you can reach HR directly at 312-751-4443.

DO:

Thank participants. Be available for 5–10 minutes after the session ends.

APPENDIX | Quick Reference for Facilitators

Key Numbers — Post in Classroom

HR Employee Relations — Harassment, Discrimination, Retaliation, Workplace Conduct	312-751-4443
Office of the Inspector General — Fraud, Corruption, Misuse of Property	312-751-4444
OIG Email	inspectorgeneral@mwr.org

Policy Quick Reference

Policy	Subject	Key Coverage for Facilitators
AP 10.5.0	Anti-Harassment, Anti-Discrimination, and Anti-Retaliation	Defines harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. Establishes employee and supervisor obligations. Internal and external reporting procedures.
AP 10.11.0	Whistleblower and Anti-Retaliation Procedures	Covers improper governmental activity: fraud, corruption, misuse of property. OIG is the primary recipient. Expands anti-retaliation protections for whistleblowers.
AP 10.15.0	Complaint Procedure for Non-Represented Employees	Three-step process for general workplace complaints NOT involving harassment or discrimination. 7-day windows at each step. Final appeal: Civil Service Board.
AP 10.27.0	Rules for Employee Conduct	General Rules, Major Offenses, and Intolerable Offenses. Addresses offensive language, conduct violations. Cross-references AP 10.5.0 for harassment.
AP 10.44.0	Guidelines for Employee Social Media Use	Governs on-duty and off-duty social media. Applies to personal accounts when content impacts the workplace. Connects to AP 10.5.0 for coworker-targeted conduct.

Common Facilitation Challenges & Responses

If a Participant Says or Does...	Facilitator Response
<i>"This is just a compliance checkbox."</i>	"I hear that. What makes this different: by the end of today, you'll know the exact number to call, the threshold for reporting, and have practiced what to say in a real scenario. That's more than compliance."
<i>"I already know all of this."</i>	"I'd expect that — and you'll recognize a lot of the content. I'd ask you to use the scenario activities to test that knowledge. Knowing and applying are different things."
<i>Participant discloses a current specific</i>	"Thank you for sharing that. This is exactly the kind of situation this

<i>situation</i>	training is designed to address. I want to make sure you connect with HR directly after we wrap up. Can we talk for a few minutes then?"
<i>Discussion becomes heated between participants</i>	"I want to make sure we stay focused on the content rather than this specific exchange. Let's bring it back to the scenario. [Name a question.] Happy to talk through specifics privately after."
<i>Participant challenges a policy definition</i>	"Fair question. Let me pull up the policy directly — AP 10.5.0, Section A. [Read from policy.] If there's still a question, HR Employee Relations at 312-751-4443 is the definitive authority."
<i>Group is very quiet / low engagement</i>	"I'm going to try something different. I want to hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet. [Pause. Direct call: '[Name], what do you think about...'] The scenario activities work best when everyone brings their perspective."
<i>"What if HR doesn't do anything after I report?"</i>	"That's a legitimate concern. HR is required to investigate reports made under AP 10.5.0. If you file externally with IDHR or EEOC, those agencies have independent authority. And retaliation for reporting is a separate violation. You have options at every stage."

Facilitator Session Notes

Date / Time / Location	
Facilitator Name	
Number of Participants	
Participant Mix (departments / roles)	
Notable Group Reactions or Dynamics	
Activities That Generated the Most Discussion	
Activities That Fell Flat or Needed Adjustment	
Any Real Disclosures or Sensitive Situations (no names)	
Follow-up Actions Required	
Suggested Changes for Next Delivery	